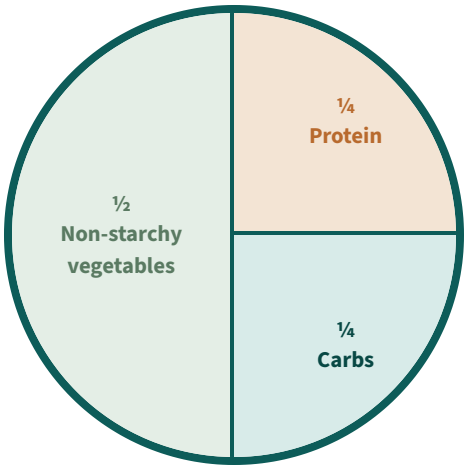
Diabetes Plate Method

A simple visual for building balanced meals without weighing every gram. Use a 9-inch plate. Adjust portions with your dietitian if you use insulin dosing or specific carb goals.



Add water, unsweet tea, or milk as planned · Include healthy fats in moderation

½ Non-starchy veg

- Broccoli, greens, salad
- Peppers, cucumber, zucchini
- Cauliflower, green beans
- Tomatoes, mushrooms

¼ Lean protein

- Chicken, turkey, fish
- Eggs, tofu, tempeh
- Lean beef or pork
- Cheese, cottage cheese

¼ Carbohydrate

- Whole grains, pasta, rice
- Starchy veg (potato, corn)
- Beans, lentils
- Fruit or yogurt

Build-a-meal examples

MEAL	PLATE IDEA
Lunch	Salad greens + grilled chicken + quinoa
Dinner	Roasted veg + salmon + sweet potato
Breakfast*	Veg omelet + berries + toast

*Breakfast often needs a flexible plate — emphasize protein + fiber.

Extra steady tips

- Fill the veg half first
- Choose water over sugary drinks
- Use smaller plates if portions creep up
- Beans can count as protein or carb — pick one “slot”
- Still count carbs if you dose insulin

Educational reference only — not medical advice. Adapted from widely used diabetes plate education models. Individual nutrition plans differ.